

Sol-fa

Fast Track





About the Course

An accelerated course through sol-fa concepts covered in levels 1-3. Through video instruction, students will practice ear-training, Curwen hand-signs, and singing intervals from the solfa ladder. The lessons include exercises in multiple keys, time signatures, and with various rhythms. Students should already be loosely familiar with foundational music concepts such as note duration, time signatures, and how to read music on the staff.

Skills Focus: ear-training, interval recognition, sol-fa syllables, Curwen hand signs, sight-reading.



Placement & Combining Tips

May be suitable for a 4th grader who has knowledge of basic music concepts.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5-12	Sol-fa: Fast Track 1 time/week 15 min	

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Sol-fa: Fast Track				
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Planning & Prep

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LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.
(No Books Assigned)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



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SAMPLE

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How To Teach



Recap

- Specific recap questions are often suggested in the day's plans; ask students what they remember from the last lesson. If nothing comes to mind at first, tell them to give themselves another minute or two and to keep thinking. Our brains are amazing and can usually recall the previous lesson with a minute of effort. Refrain from doing the work of remembering yourself if you are leading the lessons.
- For composer study, a recap might look like a brief discussion about the name or sound of the piece you listened to previously.
- For hymns and folk songs, this might be an effort to hum the melody or recite the words of the song you're currently learning.
- For sol-fa, it might be a quick explanation of the sol-fa syllable you learned or a tricky rhythm or interval you were working to master.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture or sharing something that the teacher remembers. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers may consider continuing anyway or repeating the last lesson.



Introduce

- Prepare to listen to the day's musical selection by inviting students to consider an interesting musical or historical idea in the lesson. Perhaps it's a unique word, rhythm, instrument, or piece of historical background. You might introduce it by the way, or read a selection of a composer's bio or a brief article to students.



Listen & Sing

- Listen to the day's musical selection.
- Composer study lessons will usually have you listen to a piece of music for 3-8 minutes. If students have a difficult time listening for the duration of the lesson, stop the music at their limit.
- Some students might draw, color, or engage in a handicraft while listening to help extend their listening time. Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Hymn, folk song, or sol-fa lessons will sometimes have you listen to a part of the song and then practice echoing back the melody and/or words.



Discuss

- Composer Study: Talk about the musical selection you heard. What stood out to you? What did you notice? What did it make you wonder? Did it remind you of anything? Discuss the tempo, the sound of the music, the instruments used, the volume, and the mood. Why do you think the composer wrote it the way he did?
- Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs: What lines strike you particularly? Is there a rhyme scheme to the lyrics? Is there a progression to each stanza? If you were to add a verse to the song, what would you add? If you took a verse out, how do you think it would change the song? Do the

melody and words go together? Why or why not?

- Sol-fa: Take a minute to reflect on what you learned in the lesson. Write down any notes you want to remember and practice any particular exercises that were tricky.



Connect

- At the end of the lesson, think about how the day's musical selection connects to other books, subjects, characters in history, etc.
- You might copy down a stanza of a hymn in your Commonplace or Copywork book, read a bit more about the history behind a piece of music, jot down a noteworthy date in your Book of Centuries, or discuss a broader question raised in the lesson.

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Term 1

WEEK 1  **15m Sol-fa: Fast Track - Lesson 1**
→ **INTRO**
This year we are going to learn ear-training, interval recognition, sol-fa syllables, Curwen hand signs, and sight-reading.

→ **VIEW & PRACTICE**
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Video Link: Lesson 1

WEEK 2  **15m Sol-fa: Fast Track - Lesson 2**
→ **RECAP**
Review concepts from previous lesson.

→ **VIEW & PRACTICE**
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Video Link: Lesson 2

WEEK 3  **15m Sol-fa: Fast Track - Lesson 3**
→ **RECAP**
Review concepts from previous lesson.

→ **VIEW & PRACTICE**
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Video Link: Lesson 3

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